

Task 7 - Identify and Remove Suspicious Browser Extensions

■ Objective

The main goal of this task is to develop awareness about browser security. By reviewing, identifying, and removing suspicious extensions, users can protect themselves against data theft, privacy invasion, and performance issues caused by malicious software. This task helps in understanding real-world browser security management.

■ Steps Followed

- Opened the browser's extension/add-ons manager.
- Reviewed all installed extensions carefully.
- Checked permissions, developer details, and user reviews for each extension.
- Identified extensions that were unused, unnecessary, or suspicious.
- Removed these extensions to reduce risks and improve browser performance.
- Restarted the browser and confirmed that it functioned smoothly after the cleanup.

■■ Findings

During the review, a few extensions were identified that either had poor reviews, requested unnecessary permissions, or were no longer in active use. These were considered suspicious because such extensions could potentially collect sensitive information such as browsing history, login credentials, or personal data. After evaluating them, they were removed to ensure better security and smoother browsing performance.

■ Key Learnings

- Browser extensions, while useful, can pose significant security threats if misused. - Always verify the developer and permissions before installing an extension. - Unnecessary extensions should be removed regularly to reduce the attack surface. - Malicious extensions can steal cookies, monitor browsing activity, and even capture sensitive data. - Practicing regular extension audits is a good cybersecurity habit.

■ Outcome

This task improved awareness of how seemingly harmless browser extensions can compromise security. After removing unnecessary and suspicious extensions, the browser became more responsive and secure. The exercise reinforced the importance of continuous monitoring and highlighted best practices for safe usage of extensions.